MODULE 2

CASE STUDY

MODULE 2

A French researcher bets he can out-innovate OpenAI, Google, and Anthropic from Paris

Prepare this case before class. Come ready to take a position.

THE SITUATION

Mistral AI, June 2023

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Munich, 2017–18

Daniel Metzler, Josef Fleischmann and Markus Brandl build rocket engines in TUM's student group WARR. From inside the club they keep hitting the same wall: Europe builds world-class satellites but has no flexible, affordable European ride to orbit.

KEY FACTS

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- TUM WARR rocketry group — engines built as students
- The noticed gap: EU satellites, no EU launch option
- Deep tech: capital-intensive, decade horizon
- UnternehmerTUM/TUM ecosystem at the door
- Founded 2018 · >€400M raised since

THE DECISION

OPTION A

OPTION A

OPTION B

OPTION B

OPTION C

OPTION C

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

Come prepared to defend your position with evidence from the case.

1. DISCUSSION QUESTIONS
1. Come prepared to defend your position with evidence from the case.
1. Was this idea brainstormed or noticed? What's the difference in evidence terms?
1. Run the DVF gate on Isar 2018: where were they uniquely strong, where weakest?